

CHAPTER 8: CONCLUSIONS AS TO THE CONDITIONS DEFINED IN THE ACT

205. The members of the Hard Fibre Cordage Federation (H.F.C.F.) supply all the hard fibre cordage that is supplied in the United Kingdom except:

- (a) a negligible quantity occasionally supplied by the Admiralty (see paragraph 141) (the bulk of the Admiralty's output is used by the Royal Navy and is not therefore "supplied" at all);
- (b) a very small amount produced in the United Kingdom by non-members of the Federation, the total weight of which is less than 5 per cent. of the total supplied by members: this includes ropes made from yarns spun by members (see paragraph 144) and some coir rope made from imported yarn (see paragraph 149), as well as re-made cordage (see paragraph 153);
- (c) a quantity imported from the Irish Republic, equivalent to less than 2 per cent. by weight of the total supplied by members (see paragraphs 150 and 25);
- (d) a quantity, mainly coir yarn, imported from other countries by non-members of the Federation; these imports amount to not more than 10 per cent. by weight of the total hard fibre cordage supplied by members (see paragraphs 152 and 184).*

206. It is clear from what has been said in Chapters 2 to 6 that the members of the H.F.C.F., together with the suppliers of some of the cordage described in (b) and all of that described in (c) of paragraph 205, so conduct their respective affairs as to restrict competition in connection with the production and supply of hard fibre cordage. It is equally clear that these persons supply more than one-third, and in fact nearly all, of the hard fibre cordage which is supplied in the United Kingdom. Accordingly we find that the conditions to which the Act applies in fact prevail as respects the supply of hard fibre cordage.

* Some imported coir yarn is supplied by members as cordage (see paragraph 184) but we have no figures; it is included in the 10 per cent. mentioned above.